

CLINTONCARDOZOEDIT

Travel Radio Australia and our guest this month is Clinton Cardoza from a great company called One Ridge and they do all sorts of things with airport operations. Clinton, welcome to the program. I'm glad to be here.

Yes, Clinton, tell us about One Ridge and how you came to start it. Five years ago, nearly six, I used to work at the National Carrier in New Zealand and we were working on the recertification of the airline and in some countries you have to do that every few years. And what we found is that the process of, I would say, regulatory assurance or regulatory oversight was incredibly manual.

When I dug into it further, I found that this manual nature or paperwork nature of trying to do anything in aviation is incredibly hard and we believe that there was a better way to do it, a because members of the traveling public, we want to make sure that it's safe. Safety has come at the cost of efficiency and we believe that there is a world in which we can do both things. And since then, we started a company, this company, One Ridge, and it enables a lot of aviation customers or aviation operators make their regulatory assurance quicker so they can innovate faster.

Yes, well most travellers never think about what happens behind the scenes to keep an airport running safely. What's actually going on that we don't see, and you do? Yeah, and coming back to my point that aviation sector is obviously the one that manages its safety, impeccantly. It is one of the cheapest modes of transportation and there's a big cohort of the world's population moving through that ecosystem.

The cost of that is that innovation or doing things for the traveling customer is time-consuming. As an example, airports are constantly managing wildlife on the runway, so just make sure that the likelihood of wildlife damaging aircraft is all of the way your baggage moves through the ecosystem, making sure if it's lost, how easily could it be found, making sure that while you're on the runway, air flight, let's just say you're moving through that, I wouldn't say dangerous, but more complex spaces safely. Now all of this is happening in the background and all we see is, you know, obviously we see the check-in lines or we see the security lines but there's a lot of stuff going on in the background that inherently and classically was paperwork heavy and obviously we are supporting a lot of the airports globally now to make sure that that's efficient.

So ultimately you and me as a traveling passenger can make it even more efficiently and safely through these airports. And why should an everyday traveller care about something like airport compliance? Well if you think about how you travel today and it's still fraught with a lot of friction, you know, when you are looking to travel a vehicle business, a holiday, one of the things you don't look forward to is the actual traveling process. And as you can imagine, you travel through an airport, you obviously got check-in lines and of course now that's automated and having those kiosks is made things a whole bunch better but then you go through security and that experience

completely changes because, you know, hey you're removing your bells and you're removing your computers and you know you obviously do those funny poses and security scanners.

So it's still fraught with an unhumanlike experience because it's now about safety and security as opposed to a human-centric approach. So we've given up those sort of comforts and so obviously even when you get on the aircraft, unless you pay an arm and leg for a business class seat, comfort is, you know, you're sitting in these seats. Now what we want to do or we want to help airline airports, you name it, we want them to innovate better so it suits the traveling customer.

But any sort of innovation in that environment requires regulatory oversight and regulatory approval and a whole bunch of paperwork to prove through information and data that this is safe to do it. It's how do we change from a, you know, a regulation and compliance-centric model into a customer-centric model for, you know, airport operations is exactly the thing they're focused on. So it matters to us if we want a more comfortable experience traveling through these airports and airlines, we want to make sure that there is more innovation happening and we don't want regulation to come too much in the way of innovation.

Yes and let's talk about something most listeners will never have heard of. Airports are protected by invisible layers in the sky. What are layers and why are they changing? Think about the 4 kilometer radius of an airport.

There's not just, you know, one aircraft coming, there's multiple aircrafts coming in. So that's just stuff from the sky. There's also wildlife that's flying through that airspace and once it comes closer to the ground, there's a lot of ground obstructions.

There's, you know, trees growing all over the place, there's buildings being constructed, there's trains, you name it. So fundamentally what's happening is that the airspace is not, airspace around the airport is not a static environment. Things are changing constantly.

To monitor all that change is a lot of workload. In the past it has been very, I would say, you know, brute force, blunt hammer that all the standards have to be precise and all the standards have to be prescribed. Like, just show me how you do this and this is how it is.

But obviously the regulators have realized that no two airports are the same. So why are they all governed by the same standard? So there's a precision that's coming to more, I'll say, a digital precision that is coming to the future of these layers of safety of aircraft coming in and out of these hubs. It's near impossible that these, I would say, these precision proof points in that airspace is going to be done manually.

It's going to be all done digitally. It has to be done digitally. It's the most efficient way to do it.

And for the traffic passenger, they will not see it at all. What they will see is probably fewer delays, fewer incidences in that, you know, that four kilometer radius or whatever radius of that

airport because some rules are going to change shortly. That is going to make it better for us.

Now something the listeners will love, the wildlife, what exactly is involved in keeping birds and animals away from runways? You mentioned it briefly before. There's a lot of new technology out there as well. A lot of people, obviously, they've seen the movie, you know, that of the United Flight, you know, in the Hudson River.

We've all seen that and we saw seen the implications or like that is an extreme end of wildlife in and around the airport. But the sort of non-extreme end is that airports are amazing grounds for wildlife. There's obviously birds, sometimes there's water bodies next to an airport.

Sometimes airports are next to coastal regions and there is a lot of wildlife activity. So activity needs to be managed so that while an aircraft is taking off, taxiing or a stunt doesn't hit it. And in any, even the smallest object touching the airframe, obviously it needs to be reviewed and, you know, the maintenance guys have to look at it and make sure that the aircraft is safe to operate.

So it's a heavy cost to the industry. It's obviously near impossible to tell the birds or wildlife that, hey, you shouldn't come in the airspace. Like, you know, there is no rules that they're going to follow.

So it has to be actively managed. And the way airports obviously manage it is scarras. There are like, you know, loud crackers and bangs and making sure that the height of the grass is not big enough or not long enough or short enough, that makes an ideal breeding ground for birds wanting to nest there or animals wanting to nest there.

So there's a lot of activity and efforts to all sorts of things they do. I know some efforts who have like a dog, obviously on a leech and that's constantly trying to chase after the birds. So the birds know that there is a threat there that are traps that get laid down.

And now they're starting to see the emergence of these small robotic dogs as well that are just monitoring their field. There's a lot of camera stuff as well, like cameras are constantly monitoring, saying what kind of wildlife is coming. And the more interesting piece is that the climate change is having an impact on how birds are migrating through these airports as well.

So as you can imagine, there's a lot of change, a lot to be managed. It is a constant piece of management. And that is just one part of what an airport has to manage.

And airports are small spaces, they are massive spaces. So, you know, kudos to all these airports in the world that manage this so effectively. And we don't even see this as a traffic public.

But behind the scenes, you know, it's like the duck on the water, you don't see that, you know, you just see the ducks would be operating. But deep down inside, there's a flurry of activity under the water. For the traveller listening right now, should any of this make them worried about flying at all? Absolutely not, because the layers of protection that they already exist is phenomenal.

And there is no other industry that has the layer of protection that these airport people, you know, one of the things I never do is I never complain about delays, because whatever delay has happened has probably happened because of the right reasons or safety is paramount. Like that is every safety professional, it doesn't matter. Every aviation professional, it doesn't matter who they are, always knows the importance of safety and security in those environments.

So it's still the safest. What we want to do, obviously, is make it go more efficiently, and not just for the operators, but the regulators and the travelling public. And I want to, I want to see more innovation come into the ecosystem.

I want my family to be travelling in the most comfortable way possible and enjoy the travelling experience. And what we're trying to do at Wonder, I guess, to make sure that it doesn't come at the cost of slowness and inefficiency. So how can you do both things? And that's the challenge we are solving globally is make it more efficient, make it more innovative, but not at the compromise of safety.

Yes, we're speaking with Clinton Cardoza from OneRej, which is a great company that does all sorts of compliance work with airports all around the world. And I suppose you work with many, many airports. And finally, what's next for OneRej, Clinton? I think we want to go, obviously, work on things because we have a majority of national airports in each of the countries we're in.

We have the unique view of what is probably going to happen from a national level as well, from a safety and security posture perspective. But ultimately, what is next for us is making sure that the travelling passenger has the best experience possible because all of the compliance pieces and all the regulatory pieces are well taken care of. That is ultimately why I do this is because I want to make sure that when me and my family travel, we are the most comfortable possible and we are moving efficiently.

And, you know, I want more product than the airport. So that's where we're going to head into. Obviously, the key piece is making sure everyone, all the airports are compliant and to the rules.

But the next piece is how do we help them innovate faster. So ultimately, you and me have some amazing products in our travelling journey. For industry people or people in general, really, how can people have a look at One Ridge online? Well, you can go to onereg.com. Here's a whole bunch of information.

But ultimately, it is the easiest to reach out to us and have a chat because what we've been doing is definitely novel. It is unlike anything on the market. And if you are innovating, you want to talk to us.

Clinton, it's been a pleasure having you on Travel Radio Australia. And thanks so much for these fascinating insights into the behind the scenes work that goes on in airports and the travel travel

all over the world. Thank you very much.

Thank you, Jack. It's been a pleasure.